

"YOU ARE YOUNG. YOU CAN SHAPE THE NEW WORLD."

PHASHANT PANJIAH



So said an ailing, 84-year-old Deng Xiaoping when he met Rajiv Gandhi in Beijing for 90 minutes. Rajiv became the first prime minister of India, since his grandfather Jawaharlal Nehru in 1954, to scale the Great Wall of China in December. The visit, however, failed to achieve any breakthrough in the turbulent Sino-Indian ties.

PHAMOD PUSHKARNA



REPEAT STRIKE

Operation Black Thunder, a counter-terrorist operation carried out by the National Security Guards, was aimed at drawing out terrorists holed up in the Golden Temple, Amritsar. During the operation that lasted six days, 151 terrorists surrendered.

Telly-revolution

Streets wore a deserted look. Life came to a standstill on Sunday mornings. This, from the day *Ramayan* and *Mahabharat* hit the otherwise staid television screens of the great Indian middle class. Beginning in 1987 and ending in 1988, with 78 episodes and an estimated 80 million viewers, it had events advertised for Sundays adding the caveat: "To be held after *Ramayan*". *Mahabharat*, started in 1988 and ending in 1989, also gripped the popular imagination, and was seen in 90 per cent of all Indian television homes.



● Moscow agreed to withdraw its forces from Afghanistan, promising to pull out all 1,15,000 men by mid-February 1989.

AFP



● On October 19, the Dow Jones Industrial Average lost almost 22 per cent, triggering similar drops across the world.

● Pakistan President Muhammad Zia-ul-Haq and US ambassador Arnold Raphel died in a plane crash near Bhawalpur in Pakistan. Benazir Bhutto was sworn in as prime minister, the first woman ever to head a government in an Islamic state.

3,074

was the death toll due to militancy in Punjab in the year, compared to 910 a year before, in 1987.

91

lakh tonne was the sugar India produced, making it the largest producer in the world.